

Super Raid

Mili loved kabaddi. If she was not at school or studying at home, you would find Mili at the playground.

Mili's mom was a school kabaddi champion. She taught Mili the basics of the game. But Mili's school did not have kabaddi as a sport. So, Mili taught all her friends in her **neighbourhood** and now they were a big team of kabaddi players.

For Mili, kabaddi wasn't just fun. It gave her a thrill that no other sport could. She kept asking her mom questions on how to tackle, raid and earn bonus points. "Tell me more. How would you do it?" Mili would ask, anytime she watched a match on television. Her mother was more than happy to answer.



Mili's bedroom wall was filled with posters of kabaddi players. She was a big fan of Mamatha Poojary, who was once the captain of the women's kabaddi team in India.

"I want to play like her and win lots of golds," she **sighed** every night as she got into bed. Most of her dreams were, not surprisingly, about receiving the Arjuna award from the President for her achievements in kabaddi.

There was something that **bothered** Mili though. Her school encouraged sports like cricket, basketball and football, but not kabaddi. PT class on Fridays, therefore, always made her unhappy. She always complained to her parents, "Why can't they let us play kabaddi?"

One day, Mili saw a new family moving into her apartment building. A moving truck with lots of household furniture blocked her way to the playground. She waited for it to make space and ran to the playground **in a hurry**. She only had an hour to play. Mili did not realize that she had left her water bottle at the gate, while waiting for the truck to move.

Forty minutes went by and Mili was **...exhausted**. She **looked for** her water bottle, only to find it missing. A familiar face came into her **sight** at a short distance. That person was holding her bottle. Only when she got closer did she notice that it was her PT teacher, Miss Smitha. She **greeted** her teacher, who handed her the bottle.



"You left it at the gate in a hurry," Miss Smitha said, with a smile.

"Oh, I'm sorry," Mili replied, **hesitatingly**.

"Ready to go home?" asked her teacher. Mili **nodded, shyly**.

Mili didn't know why her teacher had come to give her the bottle. But she was too scared to ask. As they walked along towards her home, Miss Smitha said, "I didn't know you lived in this apartment. I just moved in."



Mili's eyes **widened** at the thought of living in the same building as her teacher. Miss Smitha laughed at her reaction. Soon, they reached home. Before waving goodbye, Miss Smitha said, "I watched you play kabaddi. You're pretty good." Mili couldn't stop **blushing**.

A week **went by**. One day at the school assembly, after the morning prayers, the Principal requested everyone to wait for a few minutes.

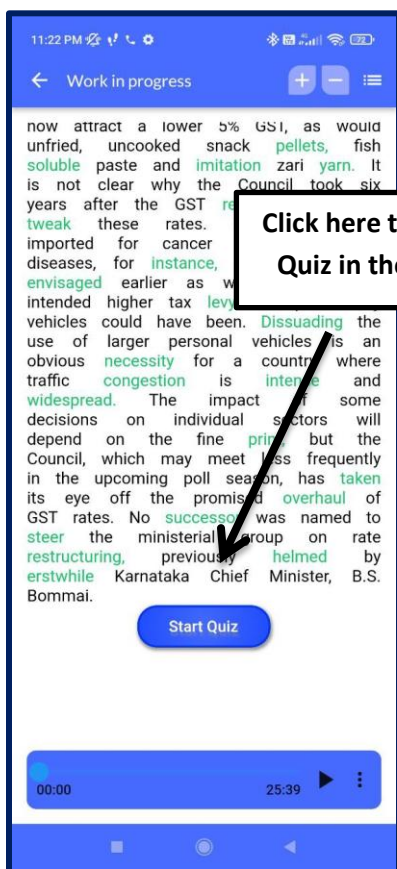
"I have an announcement to make," she started. "As a school, we want our kids to **excel** in studies, sports and extracurriculars. This year, at the strong recommendation of your PT teacher, we will introduce kabaddi as a sport," she said to **thunderous applause**.

Mili's eyes looked for her PT teacher. She smiled in **gratitude**. She realized her PT teacher had just managed a Super Raid!

Vocabulary

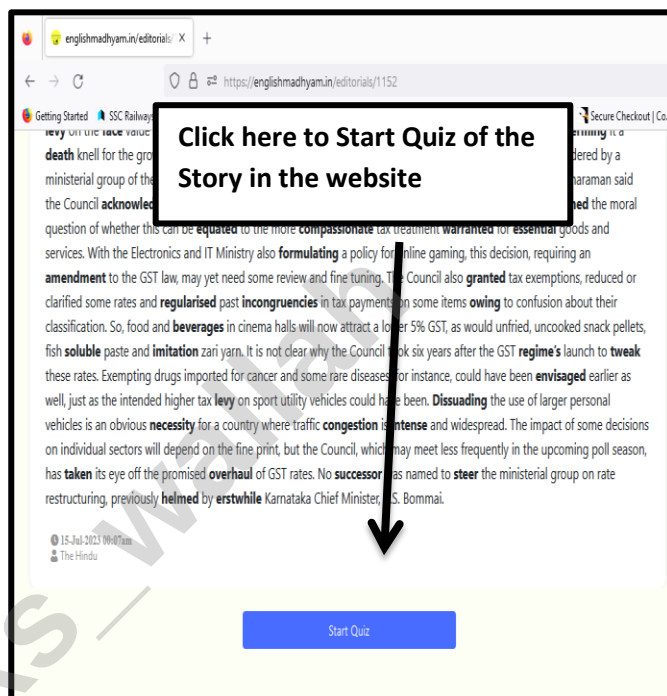
1. **Neighbourhood** (noun) – locality, area, community, district, vicinity – पड़ोस
2. **Sigh** (verb) – exhale, breathe out, murmur, moan, gasp – आह भरना
3. **Bother** (verb) – disturb, trouble, irritate, worry, annoy – परेशान करना
4. **In a hurry** (phrase) – quickly, hastily, speedily, urgently, rushed – जल्दी में
5. **Exhausted** (adjective) – tired, weary, drained, fatigued, worn out – थका हुआ
6. **Look for** (phrasal verb) – search, seek, hunt, try to find, explore – तलाश करना
7. **Sight** (noun) – view, glimpse, scene, appearance, vision – दृश्य
8. **Greet** (verb) – welcome, address, acknowledge, salute, receive – अभिवादन करना
9. **Hesitatingly** (adverb) – reluctantly, cautiously, unsurely, uncertainly, timidly – हिचकिचाते हुए
10. **Nod** (verb) – gesture, bob, agree, bow, incline – सिर हिलाना (स्वीकृति में)
11. **Shyly** (adverb) – timidly, bashfully, modestly, quietly, nervously – शर्माते हुए
12. **Widen** (verb) – expand, enlarge, stretch, open, broaden – चौड़ा करना
13. **Blushing** (noun) – redness, flush, glow, crimsoning, coloring – शरमाना / लज्जा से लाल होना
14. **Go by** (phrasal verb) – pass, elapse, slip away, proceed, move along – बीत जाना
15. **Excel** (in) (verb) – shine, outdo, surpass, be outstanding, perform well – निपुण होना / उत्कृष्ट होना
16. **Thunderous** (adjective) – loud, roaring, booming, resounding, deafening – गूँजदार / गड़गड़ाहट जैसा
17. **Applause** (noun) – clapping, ovation, cheer, acclamation, praise – तालियाँ / सराहना
18. **Gratitude** (noun) – thankfulness, appreciation, recognition, gratefulness, indebtedness – आभार

Practice Exercise



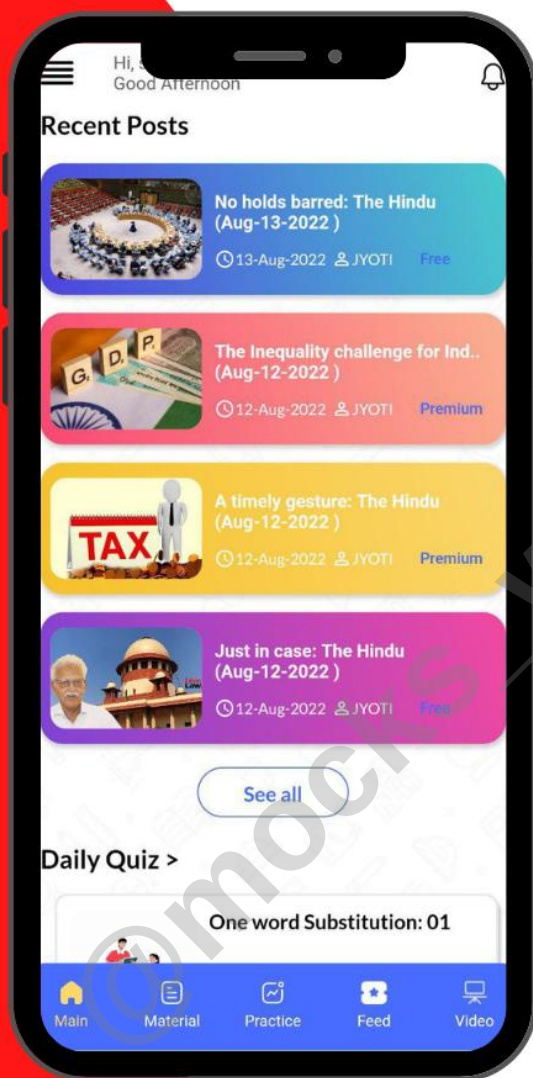
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